



# CafeBook — Why We're Different

Business Benefits vs. Other Booking Platforms

Most booking apps were built for large restaurants — then forced onto cafes. CafeBook is built **only for cafes**, which means every feature directly solves a real cafe problem. No bloat, no commissions, no losing your customers to a marketplace.

## THE PROBLEM WITH OTHER PLATFORMS

- OpenTable** Charges the cafe a **fee for every customer seated**. A busy weekend directly costs you money. Your customers also have an OpenTable account — not a CafeBook account — so they can easily be pointed to a competitor café next door.
- Resy** Monthly subscription whether bookings are made or not. **Built for fine dining**, not cafes. The platform owns the customer relationship — you are just one option in their app.
- Yelp Reservations** Customers see Yelp's branding first, your café second. **Your reputation is tied to Yelp's star rating system**. One bad public review sits right next to your booking button — you cannot separate the two.
- Google Reserve** Basic slot booking only. **No zone selection, no party-size filtering, no admin dashboard, no special notes**. You get a widget — nothing more. Zero control over the experience.
- Generic Apps** Tools like SimplyBook, Booksy, or Square Appointments are built for salons and spas. **They do not understand zone seating, party sizes, or cafe layouts**. You spend time fitting your cafe into a system designed for something else entirely.

## FEATURE COMPARISON

|                            |  CafeBook | OpenTable | Resy    | Google Reserve | Generic Apps |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|----------------|--------------|
| No commission per booking  | ✓                                                                                            | ✗         | Partial | Varies         | Varies       |
| You own your customer data | ✓                                                                                            | ✗         | ✗       | ✗              | Partial      |

|                                        |  CafeBook | OpenTable | Resy    | Google Reserve | Generic Apps |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|----------------|--------------|
| Your brand — no third-party logo       | ✓                                                                                          | ✗         | ✗       | ✗              | Partial      |
| Zone-based seat selection              | ✓                                                                                          | ✗         | ✗       | ✗              | ✗            |
| Built specifically for cafes           | ✓                                                                                          | ✗         | ✗       | ✗              | ✗            |
| Admin controls booking status          | ✓                                                                                          | ✓         | ✓       | ✗              | Partial      |
| Automatic email to customer on updates | ✓                                                                                          | ✓         | ✓       | Basic          | Basic        |
| GDPR — customer can delete own data    | ✓                                                                                          | Partial   | Partial | Partial        | ✗            |
| No monthly platform subscription       | ✓                                                                                          | ✗         | ✗       | ✗              | ✗            |
| Works independently — no marketplace   | ✓                                                                                          | ✗         | ✗       | ✗              | Varies       |

## BUSINESS BENEFITS — CAFEBOOK ADVANTAGE



### Keep Every Penny of Revenue

No per-cover fee. No monthly platform cost. Unlike OpenTable which takes a cut from every booking, CafeBook has no ongoing charge — every reservation goes straight to you.



### Your Customers Stay Yours

Customers register directly with your cafe — not with a third-party marketplace. No other platform can market to your regulars, suggest a nearby competitor, or use your booking data for their own ads.



### Zone Seating — A Feature No Competitor Offers

Customers choose exactly where they want to sit — Window, Patio, Lounge, Cosy Corner, and more. This builds loyalty and satisfaction because regulars get the experience they came for, every visit.



### Your Brand, Front and Centre

The booking page carries your cafe's name and identity — not OpenTable's logo or Yelp's review score. Customers associate the smooth experience with you, not the platform you are renting from.



### No Platform Dependency — No Risk

If OpenTable changes its pricing, discontinues a feature, or shuts down — you are locked in. CafeBook runs on your own system. You are never at the mercy of a third party's business decisions.

**GDPR Compliance Built In**

Customer consent is collected at sign-up. Customers can delete their own data with one click. Most generic booking tools skip this entirely — exposing small businesses to legal risk under UK and EU law.

**The Bottom Line**

Other platforms make money from your cafe. CafeBook works for your cafe. You keep your customers, your data, your brand identity, and all your revenue — with none of the monthly fees, commissions, or platform lock-in that comes with every other option on the market.

*CafeBook — Built for cafes that value a smooth, friendly customer experience.*